

UNIT 2 · LESSON 3

Saying Sorry and Meaning It

20–25 min · Week 10 · Co-Construct

OBJECTIVE	Students learn the three parts of a real apology and practise saying sorry in a way that means something.
CASEL FOCUS	Relationship Skills · authentic repair; Self-Management: accountability without self-punishment
VOCABULARY	sorry · apology · real sorry · name what happened · name the hurt · name the change
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · Three-Part Real Sorry anchor chart paper · scenario practice strips

ILLINOIS SEL ALIGNMENT GRADES K-2 · EARLY ELEMENTARY

Goal 2 — Social Awareness & Interpersonal Skills

2D.1b Identify approaches to resolving conflicts constructively.

Goal 3 — Responsible Decision-Making

3A.1a Explain why unprovoked acts that hurt others are wrong.

Aligned to the Illinois Social/Emotional Learning Standards (ISBE).

OPENING REVIEW · 1 – 2 MIN

Show the body outline drawings from Lesson 2. "Last lesson: feelings live in our bodies.

Today: when WE cause the heavy in someone else's body — what do we do?"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"I bumped into someone yesterday and I said sorry really fast. But I do not think they believed me. What makes a sorry REAL?"

► DIRECT INSTRUCTION

*Scripted teaching sequence · 4 STEPS · read aloud or in your own words***01 A Real Sorry Has Three Parts**

5 MIN

Build the framework: "A real sorry has THREE parts. All three matter. Without all three, sorry is a START — not a finish."

02 Part One — Name What Happened

4 MIN

Sammy demonstrates: "First — I name what I did. Honestly. NOT vague. 'I bumped into you.' NOT 'I'm sorry IF you got upset.' The real word for the real thing."

Sammy: "Part One: I name what I DID."

03 Part Two — Name the Hurt

4 MIN

Continue: "Second — I show I understand how it made the other person feel. 'I know that made you feel worried.' Or 'I know that hurt your feelings.' This is the hardest part. It means really LISTENING."

Sammy: "Part Two: I name the HURT."

04 Part Three — Name the Change

7 MIN

Final part: "Third — I make a real promise. 'Next time I will... walk slower / look first / ask before grabbing.' This is the part that says 'I mean it.' Without this part, sorry is just words." Practise together with two scenarios from the scenario card deck.

Sammy: "Part Three: I name the CHANGE."

KINDERGARTEN

GRADES 1 – 2

Stay with simpler scripts: "I _____. I know it made you feel _____. Next time I will _____." Practise in pairs with the simple sentence frames.

Discuss: what makes a sorry feel FAKE? (rushing, "if," blaming the other person). Practise distinguishing real from fake sorries in pairs.

EXIT TICKET

"My sorry has three parts" — say it together. Hold up three fingers. One: name what happened. Two: name the hurt. Three: name the change."

Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students struggled with Part Two (naming the hurt)? This part requires perspective-taking and empathy — a key Unit 3 prerequisite. Note for Unit 3 differentiation.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · Any student who refused to engage with apology language at all — may be carrying something. Do not press. Note for counselor awareness.

Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up? ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

A Note Home

Today we learned that a real sorry has three parts: name what happened, name the hurt, name the change. Try modelling at home: when YOU make a small mistake, deliver all three parts visibly. Children learn what they see.

A N C H O R C H A R T · U N I T 2 · L E S S O N 3

Print this page · Laminate for durability · Post in classroom · Keep posted all year

ANCHOR CHART · CLASSROOM DISPLAY — PRINT ON CARDSTOCK OR 11×17, POST AS THE LESSON INDICATES

ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE · BOOK 1 · THE FOUNDATION (K-2)

Saying Sorry and Meaning It

REPAIR

The Three Parts of a Real Sorry

1

Name what I DID

Honestly. The real word for the real thing — “I bumped into you.”

2

Name the HURT

I see how it made you feel.

3

Name the CHANGE

A real promise: “Next time I will...” This is the part that says I mean it.

All three parts matter. Without them, sorry is a start — not a finish.

THE ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE FOUNDATION · CONFIDENTIAL — FOR DISTRICT REVIEW ONLY

UNIT 2 · LESSON 3

CO-CONSTRUCT

The Three-Part Real Sorry

A Real Sorry Has Three Parts — All Three Matter

"Sorry" without all three parts is a start — not a finish.

1

PART ONE

NAME WHAT HAPPENED

"I ____."

Honest. Not vague. Say the actual thing you did.

2

PART TWO

NAME THE HURT

"I know that made you feel ____."

Show that you understand how the other person felt.

3

PART THREE

NAME THE CHANGE

"Next time I will ____ instead."

A real promise — not just "I'm sorry."

TEACHER NOTE

Post before distributing the worksheet. Walk through each step as a class.

SCENARIO CARDS · UNIT 2 · LESSON 3

Print · Cut vertically · Laminate · Reuse year after year

UNIT 2 · SELF-COMPASSION & SELF-FORGIVENESS · OCT-DEC

Saying Sorry and Meaning It

CUT VERTICALLY · LAMINATE · REUSE

SCENARIO · 2-E Saying Sorry and Meaning It

THE SITUATION

Isabella broke her neighbor's toy and told her mom right away. She used her allowance to help pay for a new one. But she keeps feeling terrible about it.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- ▶ Did Isabella do all three parts of a real sorry? (Name what happened, name the hurt, name the change)
- ▶ If you've done all three parts — what can you do next?
- ▶ How do you know when a sorry is complete?

SCENARIO · 2-F Saying Sorry and Meaning It

THE SITUATION

Marcus said "sorry" to a friend he had been mean to, but didn't say what he did or what he would do differently. His friend still felt sad.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- ▶ Which of the 3 parts of a real sorry did Marcus leave out?
- ▶ Why might just saying "sorry" not be enough?
- ▶ Practice: What would a COMPLETE sorry from Marcus sound like?

D R A W I N G E X A M P L E · U N I T 2 · L E S S O N
3

Visual reference for the drawing activity

DRAWING EXAMPLES · TEACHER REFERENCE

UNIT 2 · LESSON 3 · DRAWING EXAMPLE 7

THREE-PART SORRY SCROLL

Students create a "scroll" (long strip of paper folded in 3) showing their three-part sorry practice.

HOW TO DRAW IT

- ▶ **Panel 1 — PART 1.** Name what happened. "I _____ [specific action]."
- ▶ **Panel 2 — PART 2.** Name the hurt. "I know that made you feel _____."
- ▶ **Panel 3 — PART 3.** Name the change. "Next time I will _____ instead."
- ▶ Decorate with a banner at the top: "A Real Sorry Has Three Parts."

TEACHER NOTE

Students practice with a partner — one person reads the scroll, the other responds. It doesn't have to be a real situation. The practice is the point.

ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE

This is a free preview.

Sample Lesson · Book 1 · The Foundation (K–2)

The complete, classroom-ready curriculum — with anchor charts, worksheets, Illinois SEL alignment, and scripted Direct Instruction — is part of the Architecture of Grace district library. Educators can license the full set; families can find materials in the family store.

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